

Module 10 – Reflection on Learning

Zachery Thompson

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Southern New Hampshire University

Dr. Jeffrey Zheng

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Key Skills Learned

Throughout this course, I learned several important concepts that form the foundation of computer science. One of the most important skills I developed was using mathematical reasoning to solve problems. Learning about logic, proofs, sets, relations, and functions helped me better understand how computers process information and how algorithms are designed.

Another important skill was analyzing algorithms and their efficiency. I learned how to compare different algorithms using time and space complexity, which allows me to determine which solution is the most practical for a given problem. This became especially important during the final project when evaluating different routing algorithms for PackEdge Logistics. Instead of simply choosing an algorithm that worked, I had to justify why one solution was more efficient than another.

The course also strengthened my understanding of graph theory and Boolean algebra. Graphs demonstrated how many real-world problems, such as delivery routing and network design, can be modeled mathematically. Boolean algebra showed how logical expressions are simplified and how digital systems make decisions. Together, these topics improved both my problem-solving skills and my ability to think logically about complex systems.

Overall, this course taught me to approach problems in a structured way by breaking them into smaller pieces, evaluating possible solutions, and selecting the most efficient approach.

Potential Careers Relating to Discrete Structures

Discrete structures are used in many careers within computer science and information technology. Software engineers rely on these concepts when designing efficient algorithms, creating data structures, and building reliable applications. Data scientists use mathematical reasoning and graph theory to analyze large datasets and identify patterns.

Cybersecurity professionals also depend on discrete mathematics when working with encryption, authentication, and secure communication. Cryptography is built on mathematical principles that require logical reasoning and proof techniques such as those studied in this course.

Other careers that benefit from discrete structures include artificial intelligence, computer networking, database development, and systems engineering. Nearly every area of computer science requires professionals to analyze problems logically and develop efficient solutions using algorithms and mathematical models.

Application of Key Skills to Potential Careers in Discrete Structures

The skills learned in this course directly support the work performed in many technology careers. As someone pursuing a career in software engineering, I know that understanding algorithm efficiency will help me develop applications that perform well as they grow and become more complex. Instead of focusing only on making code work, I now have a better understanding of how to write solutions that are both correct and efficient.

Graph theory is especially useful in fields such as logistics, networking, and artificial intelligence because many real-world systems can be represented as connected nodes and paths. My final project demonstrated how graph algorithms can optimize delivery routes, reducing

travel time and operating costs. This showed me how theoretical concepts can solve practical business problems.

Logical reasoning and proof techniques also improve software development by encouraging careful planning before writing code. Understanding functions, relations, recursion, and Boolean logic provides a stronger foundation for designing reliable programs and troubleshooting complex problems.

Overall, this course has changed the way I think about solving problems. Rather than relying on trial and error, I now approach problems by analyzing their structure, evaluating multiple solutions, and selecting the most efficient approach. These skills will remain valuable throughout my career as I progress to more advanced computer science courses and eventually work as a software engineer.